AKTU NEXTGEN ENGINEERING

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FREE COURSES

* ITCS *

Indian Traditions, Cultural and Society

ONE SHOT + PYQ SOLUTION

UNIT-1 - Society State and Polity in India

Topics :-

→ 1. Origin of State and 4 Imp Theories [22-23] [22-23]
→ 2. Stages of State formation - [2020-21, 2022-23]
→ 3. Kingship, [Council of Minister] - [2021-22]
4. political Ideas, Conditions of the Welfare Societies.
→ 5. The Seven Limbs of the State [2021-22] [2022-23]
6. Society in Ancient India & Purusarthe.
→ 7. Varnashrama & Ashrama Stages of life [2022-23]
8. Marriage in Ancient India.
9. Gender Category & Four Class Classification
10. Women Representation and Challenges of women
11. Slavery.

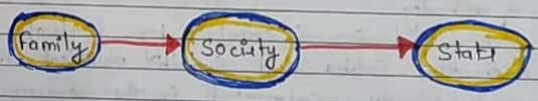
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The Origin of the State

→ "State is a Combination or association of persons that possess the authority to make the rules that govern the people in one or more societies organised of a definite territory."

→ Elements → population, Territory, Authority, Sovereignity. (Jurisdiction)

→ Origin and evolution of the State in ancient India
* One of the Greatest issue in political science.



→ In ancient India also thinkers like Bhisma, Vas, Narada, Kanwa, Brihaspati, Kautilya, Kamandaka have looked at the problem.

→ 4 Most Important theories regarding the origin of the state by these thinkers:-

a) Evolutionary Theory.
b) Force Theory.
c) Mystical Theory.
d) Contract Theory.

a) Evolutionary Theory

→ Oldest Theory of the origin of the state in India
→ mentioned in the Atharva Veda.
→ State is the result of evolutionary progress.
→ Didn't originate at a fixed time like Culture.

→ Complete Anarchy → the earliest phase of human life was the stage of Vainafya.

→ with the emergance of agriculture, stable life become possible.
→ The head of the family become the first wielder of authority.
→ Sabha and Samiti created by heads of families.
→ with the Sabha and Samiti political life began which finally culminated in the emergence of the state.

b) Force theory :- 2022-23 [2 marks]

→ Not from Indian political Thinker but Consider as Imp factor in evolution

→ "State is result and control of dominance of the stronger over weaker"

→ Earliest Aryan clans fought among themselves for pet animals, settlements and sources for drinking water.

→ Only a strong and able warrior could lead the clan in such wars.

→ This tendency continued in the days of peace also and subsequently the leader became king.

c. Mystical / Divine Theory

→ Society is created by God.
→ God sent King as his representative.

→ The exponents of this theory believe that the state did not come into being by any effort of man.

→ Kings rules by God's will, order and authorization

→ this theory criticised by western as well as Indian scholars.

d. Contract Theory :- 2022-23

→ References in → Bramanical texts
→ Arthshastra of Kautilya.
→ Buddhist Sources.
→ Most Extensively dicussed theory.

→ "Acc. to this theory state is a result of Contract b/w the king and his subjects or representatives".

→ Design to strengthen loyal authorities.

Stages of State formation in Ancient India

[AKTU - 2020-21, 2022-23]

→ Six main stages in the history of ancient Indian polity can be identified.

1. The earliest stage was that of tribal military democracy in which tribal assemblies
→ dependent on hunting.
→ Not stable
→ The age of Rig Veda was primarily a period of assemblies.

2. Second stage - Break-up of the tribal polity

→ Conflicts between the rajenya Kshatriya and the ordinary businessman called the vis.

→ The chiefs were helped by the brahmins.

→ Beginning of taxes and classes

3. Third Stage :- formation of the full-fledged state.

→ There arose large territorial monarchies of Kosala and Magadha and tribal in North-western India and at the foot of the Himalayas.

→ large standing armies and organized machinery for the collection of land revenue.

4. fourth Stage (Maurya phase) :- Bureaucratic (Naukarshahi) Centralisation.

→ based on the expanding economic activities of the state with of Arthshastra of chanakya.

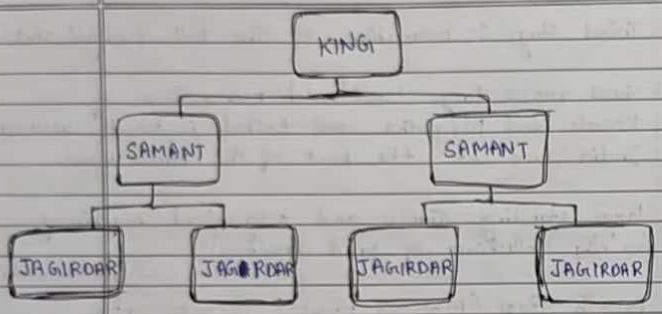
→ The state with the helps of its bureaucracy controlled various aspects of the life of its subjects.

5. Fifth Stage :- Decentralised Administration.

→ towns, feudatories and military elements came to the forefront in both the Deccan and North India.

6. Sixth stage (Gupta Period) :- Proto-feudal Polity.

→ Land grants now played an important part in the formation of the political structure made by Gupta feudatories.



Kingship

→ King was the most important figure in the body politic.
→ From Saptanga theory by Kautilya - the King has been described as the head of the state.
→ King's functions involved the protection not only of his kingdom against external aggression, but also of life, property and traditional custom.
→ He protected the family System by punishing adultery and ensuring the fair inheritance of family property.
→ He protected the rich from robbery.
→ He protected the poor against the rich by punishing.

- The Arthashastra suggests a time-table for the King's day.
→ 4.5hr Sleep
→ 3hr ~~eating~~ eating & recreation.
→ the rest of the day being spent in state affairs.

- Chakravati meaning a king who ruled over the united vast territory of the Indian sub-continent [Chandragupta Maurya]

- Asoka's time - inscriptions show to divinity.

Council of Ministers [2021-22] [2022-23 - 2marks]

→ Council of advisors have been regarded by ancient Indian political thinkers * Very Vital Organ of the body politic.
→ The king cannot do any thing without the consent of the council.
→ Appointed as minister → who possed → wisdom
→ purity of purpose
→ bravery
→ loyalty.
→ Size of council of ministers 7 to 37.

Council of Ministers

Mantrina
→ ~~large body~~
→ Smaller body
→ purohita, Sinapati yuvaraja.

Mantriparishad
→ large body
→ all the Ministers.

Political Ideas in Ancient India

→ Ideas like liberty, Justice, fraternity and nationalism are a product of the modern age.

→ Acc. Vedas independence is imp for Growth.

→ Grihasthashrama → fully independent.
Vanprastha ✗ not fully independent
Sanyasa ✗ not fully independent.

→ In Nitishastra → Niti means lead. [proper guidance].

→ At the early stages of the development of the science of polity it was known as Rajadharma.

→ In this period, word Rajniti-sastra → Nitisastra.

→ politics of the time → Brahmin, Jain and Buddhist there is a tremendous amount.

Conditions of the welfare Societies

→ welfare → happiness or prosperity of an individual in a community.

→ guarantee of collective social care of its citizens

→ Kautilya's Concept in its scope was a holistic [humanity, nature and cosmos].

→ ruler was master and the servant of his people.

→ Rather than making incessant demand for more and more rights, people could enjoy them within a limit without forgetting their duties.

→ The Seven limbs of the State - [2022-23-5th$6t [2021-22]

[Kautilya's Saptanga]

* Kautilya's saptanga theory of state illustrates a novel dimension of state power that engages artha and dharma respectively. [essential organs of the state].

1. Swami (The Ruler): means the monarch. He should be a native of the soil and born in a noble family. He should be brave and well learned.
→ make all the important appointments and supervises the government.

2. Amatya (The Minister): council of ministers
→ Give suggestions to king, collects taxes, develops new villages and cities etc.

3. Janpada (The population): → territory and people of the state.
→ territory → fertile and should have abundance of forest, rivers, mountains, minerals, wild life etc. good climate.
→ people should be loyal to their king, hardworking, disciplined, pay taxes etc.

4. Durga (The Fortified Capital): Sufficient no. of forts across its territory.
→ Forts should be built near hills, desrts, dense forests and big water bodies.
→ Durga → storage / collection.
→ hideout for the King when he is in danger.

5. Kosha (The Treasury): Finance is Imp. without it impossible to run state.
→ for paying salaries, new infrastructure etc.
→ money and valuable metals and gems.
→ It can be increased through → taxation
→ enemy states in war.

6. Danda (The Army): regular, large disciplined and well trained military → for security of the state.
→ soldiers should be paid well and their families should be taken care.
→ proper training and equipment should be made Available.

7. Mitra (Ally and Friend): Swami should maintain friendly relationship with traditional friends of his fore fathers. also make new Mitra.
→ He should send gifts for his friends.
→ bcoz they should be helped in time of emergency.
→ Imp. from foreign trade view point.
→ friends add to the power of the state.

Society in Ancient India and Purushartha

→ Society in ancient India had several diff. features. It was arranged in the form of four Varnas.
→ The purpose of life was to attain four goals called purusarthas.
→ purusarthas means "life purposes".
→ The aim of every person is to attain the four noble purusartha.

A **Dharma** : → Supreme principle of the purusarthas.
→ Dharma has a wide range of meaning.
→ It is the essential foundation of everything (Truth)
→ It is right, ~~virtues~~ virtuous, meritorious and accordingly etical.
→ Dharma in ancient India was a code of conduct for members of the Society.

B **Artha** : → Second purusartha.
→ refers to worldly prosperity or wealth. It includ all the material means of life.
→ Kautilya maintains that wealth is the basis of human requirements and the social well-being depends ultimately on material prosperity.

C **Kama** : → means worldly pleasures or sensual pleasu
→ refers to some desires and urges in human beings.

→ In the narrow sense kama means sexual pleasure but in the wider sense it involves sexual, emotional and aesthetic life all together.

D. Moksha : → ultimate purusartha.
→ means salvation or liberation from the cycle of birth and death
→ top most layer of goodness in human.

Varnashrama System of ancient India.

→ The dharma of different classes and dharma in the different stages of life.
→ most common dharma for all members of Society which must be followed by all equally.
→ references seen in the Rig Veda.

A. Brahmins : → top of varna hierarchy.
→ believed to posses great spiritual powers.
→ main functions were learning, teaching and priest hood.

B. Kshatriya : → Second class in varna hierarchy.
→ heroism, courage and strength. They constituted the warrior class.
→ duty of Kshatriyas was protection which had both internal and external aspects.

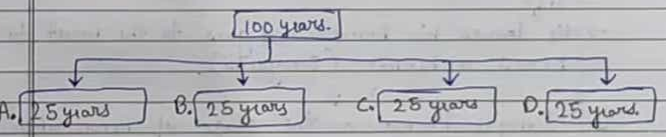
C. Vaishyas : → they were third in the social hierarchy.
→ represented the trading and Commercial class
→ expert knowledge of Jewels, metals, cloth, threads, spices, perfumes etc.
→ Ancient Indian businessmen.

D. Shudras : → bottom of the social hierarchy.
→ pursued the task of serving the other three Varnas.
→ They were deprived of various rights.

AKTU- [2022-23]

Ashrama or the stages of life acc. to Indian philosophy.

→ The ashrama in Hinduism is one of four age-based life stages discussed in Indian texts of the ancient and medival era.



A. Brahmacharyashrama or the state of Studentship:
→ first stage of life. acquiring knowledge and developing discipline.
→ Stage starts with the ceremony called upanayanam with the sacred thread.
→ Now the person become a brahmacharina, leading a celibate life as a student at the home of his teacher.

B. Grihasthashrama or the stage of House holder:
→ This stage starts at marriage.
→ ready to take up the duties and responsibilities of household life.

→ Individual gets marriage, earns money and begets children.

→ In this person pursues wealth and pleasure within the limits of the Dharma.

C. Vana prasthashrama or the Stage of Retirement from Active life:

→ In this phase, after retiring from active life, the individual dedicates himself to a Spiritual life.
→ He leaves his home and goes to the forest to become a hermit (Sanyasi).

D. Sanyasashrama or the stage of Renunciation:

→ last stage of life.
→ All his earthly ties broken.
→ leaves his hermitage and becomes a homeless wanderer.
→ Acts to attain liberation only

Marriage in Ancient India

→ Vivaha was a very important Sanskara in ancient India.
→ Marriage in ancient India had three main purposes:

1. Promotion of religion by performance of household
2. Sacrifices.
3. the happy after life of father and his ancestors and continuation of family.
4. Rati or Sexual pleasure.

→ Eight forms of Marriage:

① Brahma Vivaha: → purest form of marriage.
→ father offers his daughter with ornaments and rich dressed as a gift to a man.

② Daiva Vivaha: → father offers her daughter as a daksina to a young priest.

③ Arsa Vivaha: → father gives his daughter in exchange of cow and a bull or two pairs of these animals.

④ Prajapatya Vivaha: → father offers the girl to the bridegroom. But neither does he offer any dowry nor does he demand bride-price.

⑤ Gandharva Vivaha: → marriage by consent of the boy and the girl. Mutual love and consent of the bride and bridegroom only condition required.

⑥ Asura Vivaha: → marriage by purchase in which the bridegroom has to give money to the father of the bride.

⑦ Rakshasa Vivaha :→ Marriage by capture in which the girl was forcibly abducted from her home.

⑧ Paishacha Vivaha :→ The abduction of a maiden while she is asleep and in intoxication is called paishacha vivaha.

Understanding Gender as a Social Category

→ Man Vs Women.

→ Women were recognized as wives and also they treated as Lakshmi.

→ A woman is known as Ardhangini.

→ "Shakti" a feminine term means "power" and "strength"

→ Man was treated as the protector or sky of family. Protection and service to his family is a basic and compulsory duty of life.

→ Both man and women was treated as single unit in family.

* The representation of women in historical traditions & Challenges faced by women.

→ Indian tradition has generally respected womanhood.

→ One of the greatest is the honoured place ascribed to women.

→ Women in many places occupied an equal position to men. Many Hindus religious book (Vedas, Ramayana)

→ A man without his wife cannot participate in any essential religious rites.

→ However, in the medival period, the status of women went down considerable.

→ Customs of purdah, Sati, child marriage, restrictions on widow marriage, and the prevalence of joint family systems have been the factors responsible for the injustice done towards women.

Four - class classification

→ Four-class classification is found in Abu'l Fazl, A'in-i Akbari.

→ Acc. to Abu'l Fazal the people of the world may be divided into four classes:

A. Warriors :
→ Warriors who in the political body have the nature of fire.

B. Artificers and Merchants :
→ who hold the place of air.

C. The learned :
→ Such as the philosopher, the physician, the arithmetician, the geometrician, the astronomer, who resemble water.
→ A river rises in the drought of the world.

D. Husbandmen and labourers :
→ Compared to earth (Terrain).
→ By their exertions, the staple of life is brought to perfection, strength and happiness flow from their work.
→ It is obligatory for a king to put each of these in its proper place.

Slavery in ancient India

→ refer to a slave in ancient Indian texts is dasa.
→ "das" means finish or terminate something.
→ Associated with slaves because their work was to finish various jobs.
→ dasa word come into Vedic Age.
→ Slaves were considered to be some form of objects.
→ helpers for agriculture.
→ lower position than even the Shudras.

Unit-1 Completed

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